



NEVER BEFORE HAS SUCH A TERROR APPEARED IN BRITAIN

THE VIKING RAID ON LINDISFARNE (793)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Viking raiders

BEFORE

550–750 In Sweden, the Vendel period is a time of increased prosperity.

737 Construction of Danevirke fortifications in Denmark shows growing royal authority.

AFTER

841 Vikings establish a permanent settlement in Ireland, which will grow into the city of Dublin.

845 Viking raiders advance along the Seine and sack Paris.

867 Danish Vikings take control of Northumbria in northeast England.

911 Vikings found Duchy of Normandy in northern France.

10th century Swedish “Rus” Vikings are dominant in Kiev and Novgorod in Russia.

On a calm June day in 793, a group of men landed on the shore of the holy island of Lindisfarne in northern England, and mounted a ferocious attack on its monastery. The invaders murdered some of the monks, dragged others away into slavery, and plundered the church’s treasures before slipping away.

Population **pressure**
and **political instability**
in Scandinavia.

News of **rich targets** across the
North Sea attracts **rootless**
young men to war leaders.

**Attack on Lindisfarne
Monastery.**

Success of Lindisfarne **attack**
attracts more warriors
to join new raids.

Raids lead to **permanent**
Viking settlements.

This unexpected assault was the first recorded raid by Vikings—pagan seafaring warriors from Denmark, Norway, and Sweden—and news of it sent waves of horror and fear across Christian Europe. Over the next 200 years, Vikings would ravage and loot settlements across large